

SERIES FÉ
EDITION FIELD · A1
DATE 2026-06-22

REFERENCE × *Resort*

Why an institution preserves the truth it cannot lawfully command.

REGISTER DOCTRINE / CODEX
SOURCE FMFRP 12-80 · APPLGATE
FOLIO R / V

FOLIO R · RECTO

DOCTRINE

PRESERVATION

DOCTRINE · READ ON RETENTION

The truth you keep but *cannot command*.

FMFRP 12-80 and the preservation of unsanitizable doctrine.

THESIS

An institution that has become answerable — to law, to politics, to the rules of engagement — eventually cannot mandate the most brutal truths it still knows to be true. The Marine Corps met this limit in close combat. By 1991 it could not make Colonel Rex Applegate's maiming-first methods binding doctrine; so it did the next thing, and preserved them as a *reference* — retained without being commanded. The last-resort truth, kept legible precisely by refusing to bind it.

I · THE SANITIZATION PROBLEM

As a force formalizes, its official doctrine passes through legal review, the Rules of Engagement, and the Law of Armed Conflict. The rawest survival knowledge — point-blank lethality, permanent disablement, instinct ahead of technique — becomes impossible to codify as peacetime procedure. The hazard is not that the knowledge is wrong. It is that the filter deletes it, and the deletion stays invisible until the hour it is needed.

II · THREE READINGS OF THE MANEUVER

REFERENCE, NOT MANUAL. FMFRP 12-80 is a *reference publication*, explicitly “not intended to become doctrine.” The category is the entire move: hold the institutional memory without legally binding the force to it.

THE UNFILTERABLE CORE. Applegate’s thesis was psychological before it was physical — strip the conditioning of fair play, bypass cognition under auto-

nomic stress, commit to overwhelming pre-emptive violence. No continuum of force can hold this part, and it is the part most fatal to lose.

LEGIBILITY UNDER COLLAPSE. Target-focused point shooting over sighted fire inside ten feet; gross motor over fine; the body reverting to an “animal” state in seconds. The method is a way to keep an accurate read of a lethal moment when physiology is destroying your ability to read it.

III · WHAT PRESERVATION REQUIRES

01 RETAIN, DO NOT MANDATE. Keep the truth available; never command it. The category carries the legitimacy the content cannot.

02 PRESERVE THE UNSANITIZED TEXT. A filtered record is a lie of omission. The value lives in the unflinching original, not the version cleared for review.

03 NAME THE CUSTODY. Attribute the chain — Shanghai, to the OSS, to 1943, to 1976, to the 1991 reprint. Provenance is what makes a retained truth trustworthy.

IV · CODA

When technology fails, distance closes, and the rules of engagement evaporate, survival falls back on the primitive capacities the manual catalogs. The institution cannot order that fall-back into being. It can only refuse to let the knowledge of it disappear. That refusal — retain, attribute, do not command — is itself the doctrine.

CUSTODY

CODEX

FOLIO V · VERSO

CODEX · CUSTODY LEDGER

REFERENCE

A custody ledger for retained doctrine.

The codex renders the preservation maneuver as a ledger: each retained text named, dated, and bound to the operational truth it keeps alive — with the single act of consignment, retain-not-mandate, marked once where the manual enters the reference series.

THEREFORE: PRESERVE THE READ; DO NOT COMMAND IT.

DOCTRINAL LINEAGE

SHANGHAI → CONTINUUM OF FORCE

1910s–30s Shanghai Municipal Police — Fairbairn & Sykes, “Defendu”	1941 OSS · Camp Ritchie — point shooting refined	1943 Kill or Get Killed — 1st edition	1976 Revised & enlarged — Paladin Press	◆ 1991 FMFRP 12-80 — USMC reprint · retained, not mandated	2002 MCMAP — scalable continuum of force
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RETAINED LIBRARY · FMFRP 12-SERIES

REFERENCE, NOT DOCTRINE

IDENTIFIER	TITLE	CORE VALUE RETAINED
12-11	<i>German Tactical Doctrine</i>	Pre-WWII maneuver-warfare principles and tactical planning.
12-14	<i>Logistics in the National Defense</i>	Logistics as the bridge to combat power — the “logistic snowball.”
12-15	<i>Small Wars Manual</i>	The 1940 text on counterinsurgency and peacekeeping.
12-43	<i>Mines & Boobytraps</i>	1969 Vietnam field experience — placement and psychological use.
◆ 12-80	<i>Kill or Get Killed</i>	Unfiltered close combat, point shooting, riot control — proven WWII–Cold War.
12-109	<i>The Amphibians Came to Conquer</i>	Operational history of Pacific amphibious doctrine.

PALETTE

P.01–P.09

IRON RULES

R.01–R.05

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R.01ONE CONSIGNMENT. Compact Green appears only at the retain-not-mandate moment – the 1991 node and the 12-80 row – never decoratively.

R.02NAMED CUSTODY. Every retained text carries identifier, year, and the truth it preserves; no anonymous entries.

R.03UNFILTERED VALUE. The retained-value column states the unsanitized core, not the cleared summary.

R.04LINEAGE INTACT. The chain runs origin to successor without gaps; preservation is verifiable end to end.

R.05REFERENCE, NOT MANDATE. The ledger records what is kept available – never what is commanded.